



Graphs Using Open Flash Charts

Part—2

In the first part of this series, I gave a brief introduction to Open Flash Charts (OFC) and discussed how to draw bar charts with it. In this article, I will explain how to draw a pie chart. Since we have already discussed the prerequisites of OFC and how to set it up in the previous article, let us go straight to drawing the chart.

First, we need to define the values to be plotted on the pie chart. For our sample chart, let's look at the example of a classroom. Our pie chart will show the distribution of the number of students getting different grades in a class of 28. Our data is shown in the following table:

Grade	No. of students getting the grade
A (More than 80 marks)	5
B (60 – 80 marks)	10
C (40 - 60 marks)	10
D (0- 40 marks)	3

Now let us draw a pie chart showing the marks' distribution. Let's first store the above data to a database (I assume MySQL). Once that's done, let's create the data file, with the SQL query that fetches the data to be plotted. The data is then properly formatted and passed on to the interfaces provided by OFC, which then renders the graph to the Web page. There are several functions available, depending on the type of graph to be plotted; so select the function according to your need, and pass it the data. The

data file for our example pie chart is as follows:

```
<?php
$die = false;
$link = @mysql_connect('localhost','test_user','test_pwd') or
($die = true);
if($die)
{
    echo '<h3>Database connection error!!!</h3>';
    echo 'A connection to the Database could not be
    established.<br />';
    echo 'Please check your username, password, database name and
    host.<br />';
    echo 'Also make sure <i>mysql.class.php</i> is rightly
    configured!<br /><br />';
}
mysql_select_db('test_database');
include_once 'php-ofc-library/open-flash-chart.php';
$query = mysql_query('SELECT DISTINCT Grade, Number FROM test_
piechart');
while($queryRow = mysql_fetch_array($query, MYSQL_ASSOC))
{
    $label[] = $queryRow['Grade'];
    $dataForGraph[] = intval($queryRow['Number']);
}
```